FLOX: fluorouracil, folinic acid and oxaliplatin

FLOX is given after surgery for selected stage II or III colon cancer to reduce the chance of recurrence. It combines weekly fluorouracil/folinic acid with oxaliplatin on alternate treatment weeks.

Adjuvant stage II or III colon cancer after resection · NCCP 00486 v8 · Document revised 4 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

My overall treatment

Fluorouracil and folinic acid on Days 1, 8, 15, 22, 29 and 36; oxaliplatin also on Days 1, 15 and 29. Two weeks off follow. Three 56-day cycles make a planned 24-week course.

Treatment
Fluorouracil and folinic acid on Days 1, 8, 15, 22, 29 and 36; oxaliplatin also on Days 1, 15 and 29. Two weeks off follow. Three 56-day cycles make a planned 24-week course.

Review and next steps
Your team confirms recovery, response, course length and follow-up; changes need a revised written plan.

Your treatment schedule

Weeks 1, 3, 5	Weeks 2, 4, 6	Weeks 7-8
All three medicines	Fluorouracil + folinic acid	Planned rest, then review

Your team confirms the active phase and dates. Symptoms may occur during or after treatment; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**DPD and baseline bloods** Required by regimen	Confirm DPD testing, blood count, kidney and liver results before starting.
During	**Blood count / kidneys / liver** Required by regimen	Before each weekly treatment. Review symptoms before treatment.
During / if needed	**Nerve review / ECG** Nerve review required; ECG if indicated	Evaluate neuropathy every two cycles and report symptoms earlier. ECG if cardiac function is compromised; repeat if indicated.
After / review	**Recovery, scans / markers** Team-agreed plan	Follow the individual cancer plan; this regimen does not prescribe a universal scan or marker interval.

Between treatments

- Report fever, sudden illness, diarrhoea, mouth pain or poor intake promptly.
- Symptoms can occur during treatment, between visits and after completion.

Confirm your prescription, supportive medicines, tests and working contact numbers.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Mouth / eating

Fluorouracil

Report painful ulcers or difficulty eating and drinking.

2 Chest / heart

Fluorouracil

New chest pain needs urgent assessment, including during an infusion.

3 Bowel / hydration

Fluorouracil

Report diarrhoea, increased stoma output, severe pain, blood or dehydration.

4 Hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Report painful redness, cracking or peeling that affects daily activity.

5 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy

Fever, shivers or sudden illness need immediate oncology advice.

6 Energy / daily life

Treatment

Report fatigue that limits usual activity; ask for practical and nutrition support.

7 Nerves

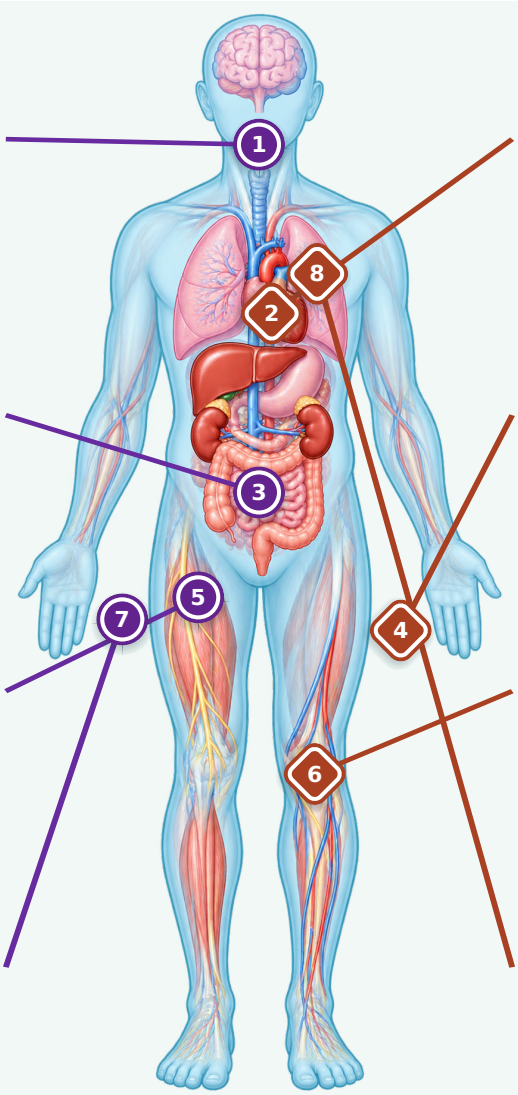
Oxaliplatin

Cold can trigger tingling. Report lasting numbness or difficulty with buttons or walking.

8 Throat / breathing

Oxaliplatin

Report throat tightness or breathing difficulty promptly; the team must assess the cause.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact oncology immediately for fever, shivering, sudden illness, severe diarrhoea, inability to drink, very little urine or unusual bleeding. New severe chest pain, collapse or major breathing difficulty needs emergency help.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

FLOX: fluorouracil, folinic acid and oxaliplatin

8-week cycle: weekly x6; oxaliplatin weeks 1/3/5; then 2 weeks off.

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 3

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.